

Chaperone Meeting Agenda

2026

1. Introductions / thank you! Who's missing?

2. Where we're going/accommodations

3. Program

- Goals: learning, fun, safety
- A brief history of the Gold Rush & hydraulic mining
(more background information provided in folder)
- Learning outcomes: basic gold rush history, diversity of people, environmental impact of hydraulic mining and decisions around it
- Parent helpers will help bring history alive (we ARE the program)

4. Role of parent chaperones

- Living history – see attached guidelines
- Characters, campfire, town characters, etc.
- Supervision & support of kids & program
- Panning experience?
- Videographer/photographers/slideshow/fast follow-up
- Other talents/contributions

5. Itinerary/program overview

6. Business

- Additional costs due to high parent interest
- Headcount, confirm drivers, # seats,
- Truck/gear
- Fingerprinting & insurance due by next Friday (deadline extended)
- Upcoming google doc: characters, roles, details, email & cell phone list
- Directions & Yuba River stop
- Other trip preparation:
 - Procure and spray paint gravel: Natalie Douglas (Danielle as back up)
 - Pouches (if needed): Breanna Casini
 - Snacks: Rachel Rinaldi
 - Penny candy: Jessica
 - Saloon food procurement: Corey & Julia
 - Coordinate letter to kids (May 1): Gaia
 - Coffee, ½ & ½:
 - Photo collection and slideshow production:

7. Other: Bring sack lunch for first day earplugs, bedding, rain gear, warm clothes, sunscreen, hat (see your child's packing list for all items)

Spotty cell phone coverage at Ross Relles.

No buying things for your child or any of the kids in transit or at the Malakoff store, please.

PLEASE don't share any of this with kids! Please convince your older children not to spill the beans either!

Questions? Feel free to email if you think of something. A google doc with sign-ups will be emailed early next week.

Gold Rush Trip Itinerary

Subject to slight modifications

Wednesday, May 13

- 8:20 – 8:30 Parent drivers arrive in garden parking lot
- 8:30 – 9:00 Gather in parking area by garden. Pack cars. Brief circle.
- 9:00 – 12:30 Drive to south fork of the Yuba River (snack in cars)
- 12:30 – 1:15 Yuba River – lunch (**DO NOT GO DOWN TO THE RIVER**)
- 1:15 – 1:45 Drive to Malakoff State Park (North Bloomfield “ghost town”); bathrooms
- 1:45 – 2:30 North Bloomfield “orientation”
- 2:30 – 4:00 Hike to Blair Trail to Ross Relles (some parents drive to Ross Relles)
- 4:00 – 4:15 Orientation & ground rules at the lodge, snacks/ parents: shuttle cars
- 4:15 – 5:00 Kids move into cabins
- 5:00 – 6:15 Trading Post activity in Lodge
- 6:15 – 7:15 Wash up/ dinner/cleanup/some free time
- 7:15 – 7:30 Go to cabins – put on evening clothes and flashlights
- 7:30 – 8:30 Campfire
- 8:30 – 9:30 Get ready for bed, cabin time, lights out

Thursday, May 14

- 7:00 – 7:45 Wake up & get dressed
- 7:45 – 8:30 Eat breakfast, clean up
- 8:30 – 9:00 Pack up for the day (water bottles, backpacks, sunscreen); group meeting
- 9:00 – 9:35 Make sack lunches (sandwich bar)
- 9:35 – 9:45 Drive to North Bloomfield/ orientation/ divide into mining groups
- 10:00 – 1:00 Rotate in groups through town & blacksmith, lunch (schedule will be provided)
- 1:00 – 1:15 Walk “uptown” to either creek or cemetery (groups will rotate)
- 1:15 – 4:15 Panning and cemetery/schoolhouse (about 60 min. at each)
- 4:15 – 4:45 Drive to overlook of diggings and then back to Ross Relles
- 5:00 – 5:30 Supervised free time
- 5:30 – 6:00 Wash up; dinner
- 6:00 – 6:30 Change into costumes
- 6:30 – 8:30 Town Hall Meeting
- 8:30 – 9:15 Get ready for bed, cabin time, lights out

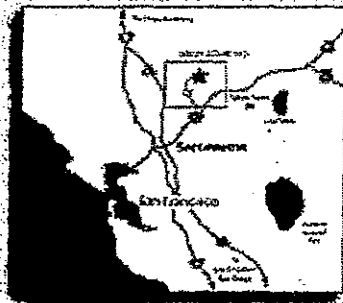
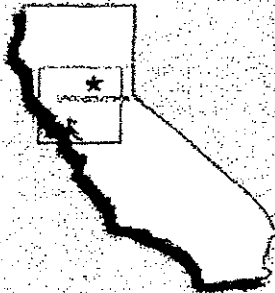
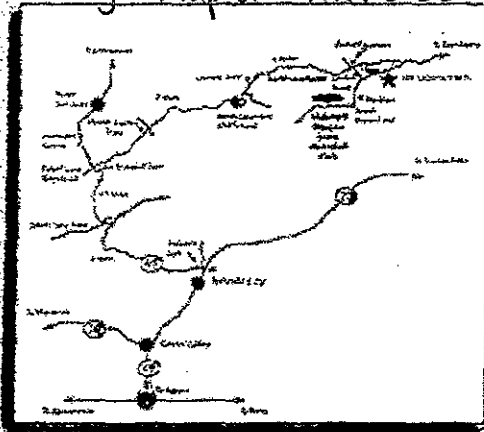
Friday, May 15

- 7:00 – 8:00 Get dressed & pack up (water bottles, backpacks separate)
- 8:00 – 9:00 Eat breakfast, pack & load cars, clean up
- 9:00 – 9:30 Make sack lunches (sandwich bar) & final packing
- 9:30 – 9:45 Drive to Malakoff
- 9:45 – 11:45 Hike the Diggings/tunnel if open
- 12:00 – 1:00 Lunch, closing circle
- 1:00 – 5:00 Return to school

CAMP ROSS RELLES

Location and Directions

Larger map on other side



[Click to Enlarge Map](#)

We'll meet
here for lunch
Don't go down to
the river!
Supervise kids
on bridge

*"Just a Half-Mornin's Hike 'Tween Humb
Creek and Mother Trucker's Store..."*

Driving Directions from Sacramento:

(Revo) - rt. fork

1. Take I-80 East to Auburn at the Grass Valley exit - 3 hrs.

2. Follow Highway 49 North, past Grass Valley and Nevada
(Note: There is no gas available after Nevada City

* 3. Just north of Nevada City, take Highway 49 left toward
Downieville.

Don't go over bridge - pull in here

4. Remain on Highway 49 as it passes over the South Fork
Yuba River. From there, it will wind for 4-1/2 miles to the
junction at Tyler Foot Crossing Road.

5. At this junction, make a right onto Tyler Foot Crossing Road

6. Eight miles ahead, you will pass the old school house at N.
Columbia. 1-1/2 miles further, Tyler Foot Crossing Road
branches left toward Allegheny and the Cruzon Grade Road
goes straight toward Graniteville.

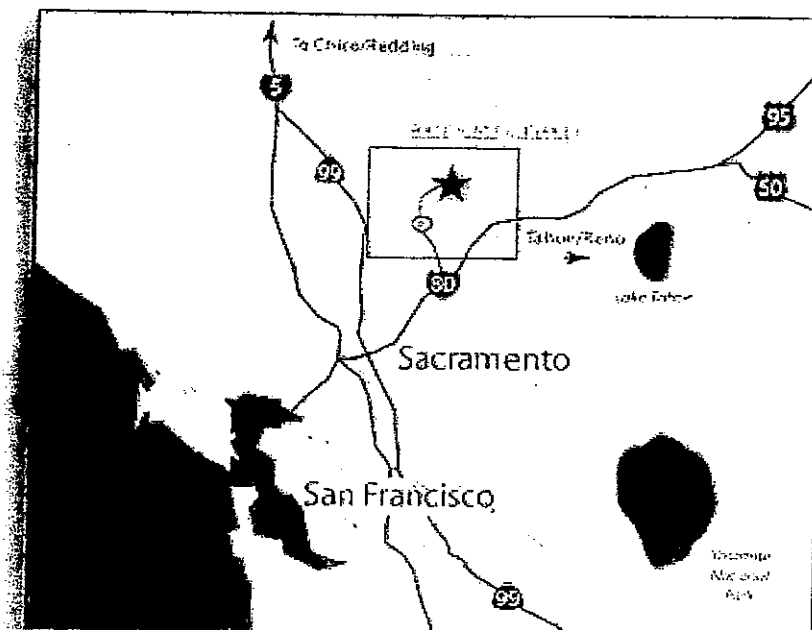
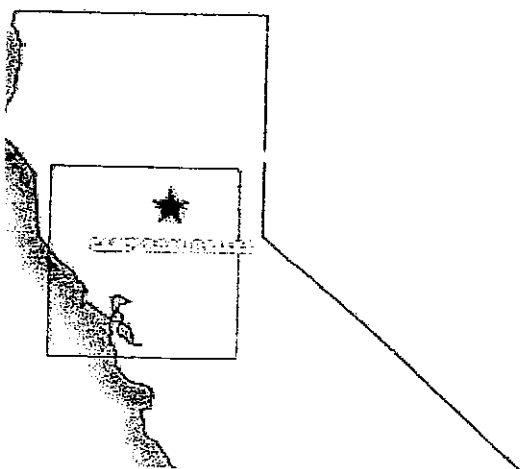
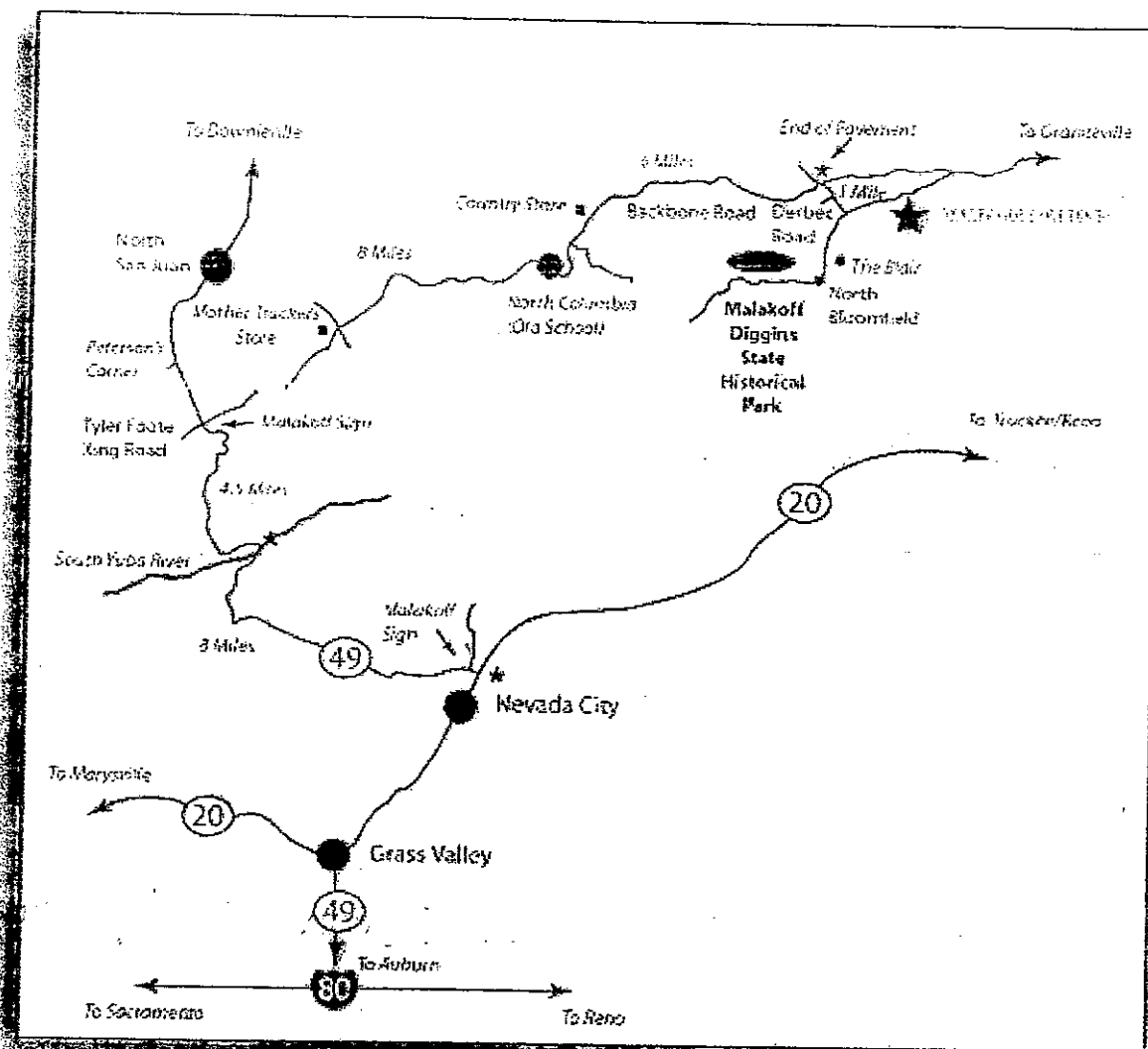
7. Follow Cruzon Grade Road for 4-1/2 miles to the Malakoff
Diggins State Park turnoff at Derbec Road.

8. Turn right at this turnoff toward the Camp. The road dead
ends after one mile.

9. Turn left and drive .2 mile to Camp Ross Relles.

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Chaperone Guidelines & Information For the Fourth Grade Gold Rush Trip

Thank you, parents, for coming along on this trip and agreeing to help make this experience a memorable one for the fourth graders. We hope you find these guidelines useful.

Pre-trip Preparation – If you are driving, your insurance forms must be current with the office. The office must have proof that you have been fingerprinted (see Suzi for this form). **Please, please** have all this done by next Friday, April 24 (deadline extended!).

Departure and return – We will meet in the parking area by the garden on Wednesday, May 13 at 8:20. **Please be on time!** Kelsey will hand out car assignments on the Monday before we leave (she will email them to you if you are driving). We will plan to be back at school by 5:30 on Friday, May 15.

Driving to and from Ross Relles – Remember to bring your own lunch on the first day. Please don't stop along the way (please no stopping for treats – this creates problems for the group!), except for bathroom breaks and designated stops. Call Kelsey (707-217-0624) or Suzi at school (707-874-1205) with any problems along the way. A list of all the driver's cell phone numbers will be distributed ahead of time, and we will set up a group text.

Special oversight – We ask that you assume full oversight for the children in your cabin while at Ross Relles. Please make sure that they are dressed, organized, eating, emotionally OK, etc. When leaving Ross Relles in the morning, make sure that kids have their water bottles, backpacks, sunscreen on, lunches and sufficient extra clothing. When returning, make sure they have all their things. Cabin assignments will be announced on the first day of the trip. If you are a parent of a same-gender child, you will "bunk" with your child. If not, you will most likely be assigned to a cabin of your gender. There may be some "overflow" cabins available as well.

Supervision – We have an ambitious schedule and program. Please help the kids with transitions, so we can begin meals and activities on time. The kids will have some free time and will need to be supervised at these times. We will provide you with a supervision rotation for free time, so that we don't always feel like we have to be "on". We will go over the rules and boundaries when we arrive at Ross Relles on the first day. Kids will be in for different "mining groups" with an assigned adult during the day. If you are one of the group leaders during the day, please keep your group of six together, make sure they eat, drink water, remember their things, etc. On hikes, please spread out among the kids. We will always ask for one parent to take up the rear. Kelsey will deal with significant discipline problems – please let us know if you are aware of any problems.

Program – Our days and evenings will be full of learning – please help the kids focus and get involved. We will provide you with rotation schedules for several of the program pieces, so you will know where to go and what to do. Because there will be so many parents, it is fine if during some of the activities you want to take a break. We just ask that parents who are socializing do so out of earshot of the activity. Our program will be all the richer if parents participate in the program by assuming the roles of gold rush characters. There will be several opportunities for you to get involved in this way, and we encourage anyone who is willing to let their theatrical side to come out to do so. The more this trip becomes a "living history" experience, the more the kids will learn, and the more fun it will be. Please let us know if you play an instrument or sing.

Specifically, we need:

- A couple of bandits for the hold-up in town when we first arrive (shhh...this is top secret)

- Several people to set up for the Trading Post Game and the Assay Office on Wednesday afternoon (preferably people who don't want to hike from Malakoff to Ross Relles)
- A couple of people to run Wednesday's campfire (and two people to build, maintain and put out the campfire). I have ideas attached to this packet and am more than open to your input!
- Four mining group leaders, who will stay with a group of six students through most of Thursday.
- A couple of people to run mining at the creek – some experience with this is preferable but not required.
- Special characters for our time in town on Thursday: saloon keeper, piano player for the saloon, general store owner, Mr. & Mrs. Skidmore, Charlie Parkhurst AKA One-eyed Charlie (delivers the mail and also makes an appearance at the campfire), Black Bart (bio attached), disgruntled farmers from the Central Valley willing to pick a fight at the saloon, pharmacist, some miners with some hard luck stories or stories of success. Maybe an engineer extolling the virtues of hydraulic mining.
- Special characters for Thursday's Town Hall Meeting – coaches for the interest groups: Central Valley farmers, miners, SF investors, Bloomsfield merchants and fisher people. Also – a bailiff, some rowdy hecklers, and possibly some expert witnesses (example – State Engineer)
- We will definitely need some committed roving photographers and someone post-trip willing to collect all photos and make a trip slideshow.
- All: providers of gold for knowledge and good deeds and other such things.

We will send out a google form early next week for sign-ups. In the meantime, you can think about what appeals to you!

You can study up on the lingo of the day as well as the people and history of this place. We have provided folders with background information for your reading pleasure (not mandatory).

Additional costs: As you know, HUSD is covering the majority of the costs associated with this trip, but thanks to your generosity, we have raised close to the other \$2,000 requested from parents. However, this amount only covers the cost for ten parent chaperones, and at this time 18 parents have signed up to come. Therefore, we will need to add a surcharge for parent chaperones of approximately \$50 per person to cover costs – maybe more for those who paid \$100 and less for parents who contributed more (it's also assumed that if two parents choose to attend, the second will cover the full cost of the additional parent, which is \$145). Once we have final numbers, we will reach out again with final calculations. We also recognize that drivers are footing the gas and associated costs of driving. Please consider pitching in to these costs if you are a passenger.

Also, please note that it is District policy that no alcohol be brought or consumed on the trip. Thank you for your cooperation with this. And **thank you SO much for your participation!**

Gold Rush Characters at Malakoff Diggings: Parent Roles

The more "colorful" historical characters that show up over our days in the diggings, the more fun and the richer the kids' learning experience will be. Characters, as well as the amazing location we'll be in, and the hands-on experiences we'll have, will bring this era to life for the students.

Day 1:

- **Upon arrival:** two bandits hold us up!
- **At lodge:** several assayers – distribute gold, claims, etc.
- **Campfire (evening):**
 - A short skit about some miners sitting around a campfire (see attached)
 - Several people: music, stories, gags
 - Other visitors from historical characters (see attached)
 - Jason: music (guitar)
 - s'mores

Day 2: Town (morning – kids will be exploring the town in their mining groups, lead by one parent leader):

Livery stable

- Charlie Parkhurst/"One-eyed Charlie (a woman stagecoach driver dressed as a man delivers the mail)
- Black Bark – a gentleman poet bandit

Pharmacy

- John Knotwell (see list of characters in your packet), or your own invented character

General Store

- Any fictional character or Henry Damon (see list of characters in your packet)

Saloon

- Lucky Dave Bowen (see list of characters in your packet)
- Lola Montez - barmaid (look on line for lots of info)
- Piano player
- Farmer prolocutor & miners in a bar room brawl
- A couple of poker players (let's teach the kids how to gamble!)

Skidmore House

- Mr. and/or Mrs. Rush Dixon Skidmore (see list of characters in your packet)

Museum

- Hamilton Smith (see list of characters in your packet)

Cemetery (afternoon):

- A couple of characters from the packet or of your own invention

The creek (afternoon - same time as cemetery):

- Lead gold-panners
- Some miners with hard luck stories - or big luck bonanza tales

Town Hall Meeting (evening)

- Judge (Chris)
- Bailiff
- Coaches for: farmers, miners, investors, townspeople & fishers
- Hecklers
- Interlopers
- Roving photographers

Parents in character and chaperones: Try to talk up the big town hall meeting - Judge Sawyer is coming to town! Discuss how you made your way to the gold fields or discuss the impact that hydraulic mining has on your livelihood

- Townspeople and miners – your livelihoods are tied to the continuation of hydraulic mining.
- Farmers & fishermen – you are in town for the meeting and are not in favor of hydraulic mining as you are having to deal with thousands of tons of tailings (residue) in the rivers and Central Valley, which is creating floods, destruction of fisheries, etc.
- Several potential opportunities to model the debate in front of the kids, which will help them later.
- While the students are with you, you can tell stories quiz the kids and offer gold nuggets for correct answers, and you can encourage them to develop their Gold Rush character, encourage them to create their own background story

Campfire Characters

The scene: Several newly arrived gold seekers are gathered around a fire, swapping stories of their journeys to California (all came a different way), their hopes, fears and hard luck stories (or stories of good luck!).

Chinese miner -

- You only get the leftover mining claims on the creek
- You realized early on that your gold wasn't worth what others was – nothing you can do about it.
- Your grandmother is worried that if you die in California, your soul will wander forever here
- You started growing food for the miners in the "China garden" and you're finding that you can make more money doing that. Some miners also come to you for health advice you know how to use herbs to cure some sicknesses – but not the gold fever.
- Some miners treat you very badly – tell you to go home, make fun of how you look and talk. Say foreigners not welcome here.
- You plan to go home as soon as you make enough money to pay your passage and bring some extra money home to your family.
- Why did you choose to come to North Bloomfield?

Yankee Argonaut

- You came around the Horn – long, and boring (six months at sea)
- Food was terrible but the boredom was worse
- 183 passengers in all – all men except for one 12 year old boy
- Captain of the ship was in a race with another ship – whoever won got a clipper ship
- Captain Swain (aka "the wild bull of the sea") won the race, mostly by risking all your lives to go through the deadly Strait of Magellan.
- Who have you left behind? Where are you from? Profession?
- Your hopes and fears, plans and how it's going so far
- Why did you choose to come to North Bloomfield?

One who took the Panama Route

- You also came from the East Coast, but decided to take the short cut
- Tell how that went
- Who have you left behind? Where are you from? Profession?
- Your hopes and fears, plans and how it's going so far
- Why did you choose to come to North Bloomfield?

Pioneer mom who took the Overland Trail

- Describe the hard journey across the country
- Even though you were part of a "wagon train" – 25 covered wagons, most people walked at a rate of about three miles per hour
- Each night, you'd circle up the wagons to make camp, and sleep under the stars

- The worst part was getting those wagons across rivers and deserts
- It took five long months.
- At the end, the journey was so difficult coming over the Sierra Nevada, people dumped some of their precious possessions over – after carrying them all that way.
- Who have you left behind? Where are you from? How many children do you have?
- Your hopes and fears, plans and how it's going so far
- Why did you choose to come to North Bloomfield? (maybe your husband is an engineer who has been hired to work for the North Bloomfield Mining Company and you have a job lined up to work at the general store?)

Gold seeker from Mexico

- You came overland – long hot journey on foot (one mule to carry things)
- You hope to make some money fast and go home
- You have cousins who own a beautiful rancho in Sonoma County – you stayed with them before coming up here
- You are surprised to find some of the Americans from the East Coast – Yankees – are unfriendly to the Mexican miners – they act like this land is already theirs, even though this land all belonged to Mexico until very recently.
- Why did you choose to come to North Bloomfield?

Other possible character appearances:

John Muir – he was exploring the Sierra Nevada at this time!
 A Maidu or Nisenan Indian on the arrival of the gold seekers
 One-eyed Charlie
 Black Bart
 Some of the town's "local color"

Wednesday: On Becoming Miners and Getting a Grubstake

- I. Activity upon arriving at Malakoff (Susan in the picnic area): Walk back in time through the decades to 1849. At the moment this ends ("open your eyes") – the bandits come out.
- II. The hold up
 - As part of the stick up, it becomes clear that the students have no gold, and are, in fact, "greenhorns". Also, upon confirmation with their teacher, it becomes clear that they haven't paid for a place to stay or food to eat.
 - Bandit then offers them a "grubstake" – a loan. He tells them that he has a place that they can stay that has good food, but that they will owe him. They will go panning tomorrow, and he's expecting great things from them (and to be paid back)
- III. After the stick up, students become miners.
 - We all encourage the kids to invent their character – where are they from? Why did they choose to uproot and come to the Mother Lode in California? How did they get here? What was their trip like? What are their hopes and fears?
 - Kelsey and Susan distribute color-coded bandanas to mining groups. Bandit tells them that they'll get their grubstake at the accommodations.
- IV. Hike to Ross Relles. (Susan leads) On the trail – character development. Adults can share their stories too.
- V. At Ross Relles, after orientation (Susan) and moving into cabins: Students report to lodge, where they play a "Trading Post Game":
 - Grubstakes (miner's bucks) are distributed and students engage in a game in which they pay for their lodging and food, procure supplies, gamble, earn money and get taxed.
 - Students must then trade in their miner's bucks for gold, pay for a mining claim (several good sized nuggets – varied depending on bandana color*) and provide their miner's name.
 - Make their first payment for their food and lodging at Ross Relles.

*RE: bandana color: this is an embedded feature that will highlight differences in how people were treated – how prejudice felt on the receiving end and as witnessed.

- Argonauts (red bandanas) receive the most discrimination – counterparts were the Chinese, Natives, African Americans, Mexicans
- Eureka (gold bandanas) will be favored and are most like the white Americans
- Greenhorns (green bandanas) are just that
- Bonanza (blue bandanas) – more subtle discrimination – more like the Europeans, South Americans

The Town Hall Meeting

The town hall meeting is the culmination of the first two days. Students will dress up and appear as one of the following (these roles will be determined prior to the trip, mostly based on which costume they go for).

Ideally, we will have inundated the kids with information about hydraulic mining throughout the day – pros and cons – and talked up the “big meeting” to be held in town that night, officiated by Judge Lorenzo Sawyer. There might have even been some brawling in the saloon earlier that day!

The “interest groups”:

- Central Valley farmers whose farms downstream are being flooded with mud and debris from the operations at Malakoff. They are outraged.
- The miners: many of these miners started out mining the old-fashioned way – panning alone or in small groups. However, most of these miners now work for the North Bloomfield Mining Company as hydraulic miners. Either way, their livelihood is dependent on this enterprise.
- The North Bloomsfield merchants: Like the miners, the merchants depend on the economy of the “company town”. They don’t want to see the operations cease.
- The fishers – These are people in the area whose livelihoods depend on clean rivers and creeks. They see firsthand what hydraulic mining is doing to the waterways.
- The investors: Mostly from San Francisco, these investors have sunk a lot of money into this enterprise and have a stake in it continuing.

Judge Sawyer was an actual judge who in 1884 ruled the hydraulic mining at Malakoff was to essentially be halted. (It imposed strict laws regarding debris and closed all loopholes). His ruling was 225 pages long, was front page news all over the state, and is considered to be the first environmental ruling in the United States.

Susan will set the stage and organize the kids. One or two parents will coach (not take over) the interest groups as they make their opening statements, rebuttals and closing statements. The proceedings will be overseen by our very own Chris, as Judge Sawyer.

Things will likely get pretty passionate! Lots of fun and learning guaranteed. After the ruling is announced (no spoilers, please!!!), Susan will bring the kids back to 2025 and will debrief the town hall meeting.

Potential parent roles (besides coaches): bailiff to remove people out of line (parents are sometimes the worst offenders!), a character who shows up who does not have a seat at the table (Chinese miner, Native person) who is told to leave, a state engineer to testify of the wonders of hydraulic mining, etc.

Some Local Color

Mary & John Blake owned and ran Ostrom Livery Stable. In those days, horses were the main form of transportation. You couldn't just park your car the way you do a car. If you came to a town, you had to leave your horse at a livery stable where someone could watch and take care of your horse. If you needed a freight wagon, fancy buggy, or another horse, you could rent one here. If you needed a cheap place to stay while you were prospecting in the area, you could sleep up in the hayloft.

Willy Blood was a miner at Derbec. During a game of cards, he was shot through the heart. He was only 22 when he died in 1885. Will McKuan was sentenced for 10 years at Folsom Prison for the crime. Willy Blood is buried in the North Bloomfield Cemetery (look for a weathered wooden tombstone).

Rush Dix Skidmore ("Skid") came to N. Bloomfield in 1857 as a baker and later got into the saloon business. He also loaned money to local miners. All the loans were done verbally, but Skid would also write it down in his black book. When a debt was past due, Skid asked the miner for the money. If the miner "forgot" about the debt, Skid would show him the black book. The miner always paid up. Skid knew all about US History and also sponsored the town baseball team.

Charlie Parkhurst drove stage for a living and was a good driver, at that! Charlie was a good shot, and was famous for having ended the life of a much-feared bandit. Charlie wore a patch over one eye, having lost the eye in a fight. The thing that no one knew until Charlie died in 1880 was that Charlie was a woman. She would dress in men's clothes with a scarf around her neck to hide the fact that she didn't have an Adam's apple. In 1868, Charlie was the first woman to vote, even before women were granted the vote, because everyone thought she was a man! She is buried in Aptos, California (she drove the stage between Aptos and San Jose).

Michael Cummings came to North Bloomfield from Ireland by way of the Isthmus of Panama. He worked for the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company for over 30 years. It was a hard and dangerous job. He and his brothers all worked in the mines. His brother, Edward, owned the dance hall. Michael died when a blast of dynamite exploded prematurely. He was 57 years old, and is buried in the N. Bloomfield Cemetery. His daughter, Mary died of diphtheria at 8 years of age.

Lucky Dave Bowen worked down in the diggings. While the monitors were operating, they shot water at such pressure that a hillside 500 feet away would crumble and wash away. So much land was moving that the mines had a watchman on duty to watch for mudslides and cave-ins. One day, the cry came too late for Dave Bowen. A mudslide covered him completely. A quick count alerted the other men to his absence. A second slide happened before anything could be done. He got to be called Lucky Dave Bowen because of this second slide. It

uncovered his head! He was alive! The other men dug him out with their bare hands & he survived.

Mr. Smith runs the blacksmith shop in town. He came here trying to seek his fortune by panning gold. As a skilled blacksmith, he found that he could make a better living making Penstock Pipes for the Malakoff Mines, helping them make the pipes fit together. He also made horseshoes, pots, pans, and even hydraulic monitors! He made far more money smithing than he ever did panning.

Old Man Eaves made his living by ground sluicing in the ravines and as a watchmaker. He lived out in a cabin in the woods with a dozen or more cats. He loved to dream of flying through the air as the birds did. People told tales in town of how he once built himself a pair of wings and leapt from a high rock and nearly broke his neck.

John Knotwell was part-owner of the Smith-Knotwell Drug Store in town. He was also a justice of the peace, a supervisor on the county board. If you had sore muscles from working hard in the mines, or a stomach ache from eating a poor diet, or a cough or a rash, Mr. Knotwell could fix you up. Many of the remedies of the time contained morphine, a powerful painkiller. They didn't really treat the illness; you just couldn't feel the pain anymore! He died of pneumonia in 1901 at the age of 66. He's buried in N. Bloomfield Cemetery.

Ah Coon lives in the Chinese section of town called the Chinese Garden. He was a cross looking fellow, and most kids steered clear of him. However, when you got him down by the river, he was an expert panner. With a few motions, he easily held the pan in one hand and washed the gold.

Doc DeMillieu ("Du mee yer") is a Frenchman, loyal to France, but also to N. Bloomfield. He's always there to help when he's needed, whether for pulling teeth, delivering babies, or sewing up wounds. He traveled to his patients' houses by horse & buggy. He loved music & played the clarinet in the town band.

Pinky was the bookkeeper/paymaster for the Malakoff dam building crew at Sawmill Flat. He kept people on the payroll who didn't exist. He would forge the boss' name on the checks, and once a month, he and some buddies would go "down below" to Nevada City to cash the checks and have a weekend on the town.

Benoit Fauchery was a French engineer who designed the Magenta Flume. This aqueduct was a feat of engineering, and carried water across a deep canyon to feed the monitors in the Northern Mines. The Magenta Flume was 1400 feet in length, and was 160 feet tall. It was built from wood from trees in the vicinity. It was built in 1859, and when the work was completed, a great celebration was held. French and American flags were raised, cannons fired salutes, and daring ladies and gentlemen walked across the flume.

Hamilton Smith engineered the N. Bloomfield tunnel to empty the tailings from the diggings pit into the S. Yuba River. The tunnel measured 300 feet deep and a mile and a half long. To finish the job quickly, they dug down in eight places and connected the tunnel underground in a year and a half. This was part of the 3 million dollars invested by San Francisco businessmen to set up the water reservoirs, flumes, ditches, and tunnel, making N. Bloomfield home to the largest hydraulic operation in the world.

Old Franka used to be known as Black Frank because of his thick black beard, hair, and eyebrows. He was a quiet man who most often began an answer to a question by saying, "wella suh" (well, sir). He had a lot of pride, and wouldn't accept help for anything. He died in his sleep and is buried in the N. Bloomfield Cemetery.

Jim Harrington was a watchman at the Malakoff mine and lived in the deserted Malakoff Hotel. It had about 20 rooms. Jim was a filthy man, never did dishes or cleaned house. When one room got too stuffed with junk, he just moved on into the next room.

The following are some summaries of folks who lived in or near North Bloomfield & how they lived & died. Some of them are in the cemetery and can shed some light on how hard life was for folks back then.

Francis Blain was a French Canadian who came to N. Bloomfield in 1854 and obtained 60 acres of land for mining and agriculture. The N. Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company was able to obtain about half of his property, his home, and his mine through legal procedures in 1874. The part the company owned is now known as Blair Lake and the Cummings house in town. He's buried in N. Bloomfield Cemetery.

Cordelia, Elvena, and Florentina Gaus were all children born in N. Bloomfield who died from tuberculosis carried by the family's milk cow. They are buried in N. Bloomfield Cemetery.

Jean Baptiste Ledu came from France to mine in this area in 1856 & worked the Ledu Mine with his son Francis. He & his family are buried in the cemetery.

Charles Marr was a native of Italy. When he died in N. Bloomfield, over \$4,000 was found hidden all over his home.

John Martens came from Germany and made his way to N. Bloomfield after living in Mississippi. He made his living by farming, blacksmithing, and mining. He was killed in an accident at the Malakoff Mine & is buried at the cemetery.

Louis Miller was a native of Germany who was the proprietor of a public house at Humbug. He refused to let Charles Davis take his daughter to the circus. A fight broke out, was taken

outside. A gunshot was heard by the wife & daughter. Miller collapsed while coming up the stairs. Davis was convicted of murder & sentenced to one year in San Quentin.

Arthur Monroe died at 40 years of age from injuries sustained when he broke his leg.

Caleb Nash operated the general store in N. Bloomfield from 1856 until it burned down in 1869. He was postmaster of town 1863-1870. His wife and daughters were seamstresses and gave piano lessons. He died at the age of 55 and was buried in town.

Michael Perfumo disappeared on 1/10/1858 when he left to go from Humbug to Marysville. His injured dog was found, along with his hat, coat, and shoes, which were found with blood on them near the river and an old mine shaft.

Julius P. Poquillon committed suicide on 6/10/1876 in San Francisco at 45 years of age. He built a hotel in Lake City in 1860, subdivided the land, and sold memberships in the Lake City Yacht Club. He then bought up many claims in the Bloomfield area, when to San Francisco investors who acted on his idea and formed the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company.

Eddie Sherwood died when he was 2 years old after he drowned in a rain barrel behind the family home.

David Stokes invented and patented the steerable monitor while he was employed by the N. Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company. He was a native of Switzerland and died when he was 39. He's buried in the cemetery.